

As a freelancer in the simulated project, you will build a functional customer support chatbot that could be used by a small e-commerce business specializing in outdoor apparel and camping gear.

All required business context, data, and requirements are provided below.

1. Brand Persona

- a. Name: North Star Support Bot (or similar)
- b. Tone: friendly, helpful, outdoorsy, concise
- c. Audience: North American outdoor consumers

2. Core Use Cases (required)

- a. The chatbot must handle:
 - i. **Order Tracking**
 - 1. Ask for order number
 - 2. Return simulated status
 - ii. **Return & Exchanges**
 - 1. Explain return policy
 - 2. Provide returns link
 - iii. **Product Recommendations**
 - 1. Ask 1-2 clarifying questions
 - 2. Recommend product category
 - iv. **Human Handoff**
 - 1. Handle fallback or explicit request
 - 2. Transition to “Live Agent” state

3. Functional Requirements

- a. **Intent Recognition**
 - i. Handle variations (e.g., “Where is my order?” vs. “Track my package”)
- b. **Conversation Flow**
 - i. Logical, guided interactions
 - ii. Return user to main flow after resolution
- c. **Mock Order Handling**
 - i. Use the following order status information exactly as provided:
 - 1. Order #111 -> Shipped, arriving tomorrow
 - 2. Order #222 -> Processing, ships in 24 hours
 - 3. Order #333 -> Delivered (ask follow-up if needed)
 - 4. Any other order -> invalid order
- d. **Customer Support Information**
 - i. Your chatbot must accurately provide the following information when responding to customer inquiries:
 - 1. Return Policy
 - a. 30-day returns
 - b. Items must be unused
 - c. Original packaging required
 - 2. Shipping Information:

- a. Standard shipping: 3-5 business days
- b. Expedited shipping: 1-2 business days

e. Human Handoff

- i. When a user requests a live agent or reaches a fallback scenario, the chatbot must:
 - 1. Transition the user to a simulated Live Agent state
 - 2. Clearly communicate the handoff
 - 3. Allow the user to return to the main menu or continue interacting with the chatbot after the handoff
- ii. Fallback Handling
 - 1. Clear “I didn’t understand” response
 - 2. Offer options or escalation

4. Provided Materials

- a. **Return Policy:** 30-day returns, unused items, original packaging
- b. **Shipping:**
 - i. Standard: 3-5 days
 - ii. Expedited: 1-2 days

5. Constraints

- a. No deployment required
- b. Use provided data only
- c. Ensure flows are clear and functional
- d. Keep implementation practical and testable

6. Evaluation Criteria

- a. Coverage of all required use cases
- b. Quality and clarity of conversation flows
- c. Accuracy of responses based on provided data
- d. Effectiveness of intent handling
- e. Overall usability of chatbot experience

7. Deliverables

a. Testing Requirements

- i. Your submission must be fully reviewable at the time of submission. Evaluators should be able to access and test your chatbot without:
 - 1. Adding API keys
 - 2. Purchasing subscriptions
 - 3. Creating additional accounts
 - 4. Completing implementation steps on your behalf
- ii. If your implementation requires external services, provide a fully testable version or access that allows evaluators to complete the required review

b. Chatbot Implementation

- i. Exported bot file OR Code Repository (with instructions)

c. Video Demo

- i. 2 - 3 minute recording
- ii. Must demonstrate:
 - 1. All 4 core use cases

2. At least one fallback scenario

d. Submission Checklist

- i. Before submitting your work, confirm that:
 1. All four required use cases are implemented
 2. Order tracking follows the provided mock data exactly
 3. Return policy and shipping information are included where required
 4. Intent recognition supports multiple user phrasing variations
 5. Fallback handling is implemented
 6. Users can return to the main menu after a human handoff
 7. The chatbot can be reviewed without API keys or additional steps
 8. Your video demonstrates:
 - a. All four use cases
 - b. At least one fallback scenario
 9. All required deliverables are included and clearly labeled

SLA Expectations

As part of the Upwork Talent Accelerator program, you are expected to work within specific timeframes at each stage of the process. Your submission will be evaluated exactly as submitted. Evaluators will verify that your chatbot:

- Meets all project requirements
- Accurately follows the provided business rules
- Is complete and fully testable
- Includes all required deliverables.

Here's what's expected of you:

- **Review & Accept Contract (within 24 hrs)**
 - When you receive your contract, review the scope and confirm your acceptance within **24 hrs**. *Work should not begin until contact is accepted.*
- **Complete & Submit Work (24 - 48 hrs)**
 - Once you have accepted the contract, begin work promptly and complete and submit all required deliverables within **24 - 48 hours**
- **Acknowledge Outcomes (within 24 hours)**
 - Once feedback or a decision is shared (approved, revisions requested, etc.) review and confirm steps within **24 hours**.
- **Complete Revisions (within 24 hours)**
 - If revisions are requested, update and resubmit your work within **24 hours**